



Advertisers can now target you based on your personal preferences.

In January 2012, Google announced “Search, plus Your World”, a development of Social Search where Google integrated Google+ follower results in the search. It included ability to personalise search results and also included G+ profiles in the search. Facebook Graph search also builds on the idea of social graph.

For marketers too Social Search keeps track of brand mentions you do on social networks and accordingly alters your results. At present Bing successfully does this by pulling results from Gmail, Twitter, Facebook etc in a dedicated social column. “People and Pages on Google+” is a dedicated column on Google search that shows only results from G+.

In the past, whenever we had doubts about let's say where to get a haircut in Mumbai, we use to ask our friends or colleagues around us by emailing or calling them, but with social graph you can actually do the same thing with a single search query and get the most appropriate options. Bing now allows you to search your friends photos on the search engine and shows them in a pinterest style layout. And you can even search the captions of the photos. So now go and search something cool on Facebook and see what your friends to say about it. But wait, if you just want to shout out, without wanting to type, Voice Search is the answer.

## Conversational Search: Talk it out

Voice search lets you speak out your search queries and you get text results. Conversational search on the other hand gets you the result in the form of voice output. Yes, so now your computer talks to you. Google Conversational Search and Apple's Siri are two encouraging first steps in this space.

Apple's Siri voice search was introduced in Apple iPhone 4 and is like those Sci-Fi movie personal assistants that help you to find places and remember meetings. Siri is like your girlfriend who slowly gets to know your individual preferences over time, learns about you and tells you



### Google Graph Search

what you want to hear. Google's conversational search is also an attempt to compete with Siri.

Google's conversational search is available to any Chrome user who has an updated version. You can just speak to the search giant and it speaks back to you. Though it is still in development and is not very accurate, it is still the start of good things to come. When we asked Google about “Priyanka Chopra”, it could understand the term and threw up information about her. But when we said “Shahrukh Khan”, the results were about

the movie *My name is Khan*. Wonder why Google loves Priyanka more than SRK. The search also recognises the importance of past queries in a conversation and takes your past queries in consideration. For example, you ask “Who is Barack Obama” and then you follow it up with “Who is his wife”, Google automatically realises the “his” in the second query. Very cool indeed. At the time of writing this story Google rolled out a feature that allows people to search by saying “OK Google” as with Google Glass voice command “OK Glass”! Google Now for mobile also has voice search. While comparing Google Now and Siri, experts believe that Google Now is smarter. It could answer when a local Starbucks shop opens, which Siri could not.

If you haven't tried Google Now voice assistant, go try it now. Use it to set alarms, schedule meetings, check real time weather and traffic conditions and a lot more. With Apple's Siri and Google Now, not only did voice search become the next cool thing to do, but these and other awesome apps bring the power of search to your mobiles in new and extraordinary ways.

## Mobile Search: Search Everywhere

With everything around you going mobile, why would search stay back? Studies suggest that desktop/laptop searches are



### Google Knowledge Graph